case, the central government was left with no choice but to use force to dispel the crowds, in the larger interest of the health of the population. However, with an already anti-farmer media label quickly building up, imagine the reputational damage of images of the Armed Forces dismissing crowds of farmers circulating in the media would have done? All in all, this was a double-edged sword, if the GoI didn't act to dispel the protestors, the virus would get an opportunity to spread unchecked and if it did act by bringing in the Armed Forces, the media would be ruthless building a narrative of police brutality being used against peaceful, protesting farmers.



**9 DECEMBER 2020**

INDIA | 3,75,137 ACTIVE CASES | 1,42,684 DEATHS

WORLD | 1,42,52,240 ACTIVE CASES | 16,75,358 DEATHS

On 4 December, Pfizer had applied to the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) to seek approval for emergency use authorization of its vaccine candidate after it had secured such clearances in the UK and Bahrain. SII and Bharat Biotech too applied in the following days to come, after which CDSCO scheduled an expert committee meeting on 9 December to review all the three applications. In the meeting, Pfizer failed to submit to the DCGI any adequate data and details required for a decision to be made on the approval process. They sought more time for making a presentation before the committee.[21] It seemed like they came to the meeting only to demonstrate that they were ahead of the rest and intimidate competition, but didn't seem very serious about getting the emergency use authorization from the DCGI at that point in time. They weren't supplying bulk vaccines to European countries yet and hence didn't have adequate data on the effect of the vaccine on ethnicities other than those in the US who had received their shots either.

In the 9 December meeting, the subject expert committee constituted by the CDSCO asked SSI to submit updated safety data of phases II and III clinical trials carried out in India as well as immunogenicity data from the clinical trial in the UK in addition to the outcome of the assessment of the UK's Medicines and Healthcare products Regulatory Agency for grant of emergency use authorization. Bharat Biotech had only submitted the interim